Name: .....
ID: .....

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الجامعة العربية المفتوحة
Arab Open University

Arab Open University
FACULTY OF LANGUAGE STUDIES
E304B
Exploring English Grammar (II)
All Branches
MTA Exam

2025-2026 / Fall
Date: 19 Nov. 2025
9:30 – 11:30

Section: _____

Number of Exam Pages: 12 (Including this cover sheet)	**Time Allowed:** **2 hours**

INSTRUCTION

1. Allow approximately 10 minutes to read the instructions on this page and to read through whole examination paper.

2. There are TWO parts to this MTA examination paper:

Part A (20 marks): There are FOUR practical questions. You are required to answer all FO questions.

Part B (10 marks): There are TWO essay questions. You are required to answer only ONE.

3. Carefully follow the instructions in each part.

4. In your answer, make sure that you:

- Write the number of the question that you decide to answer.

- Cross out any rough notes you make that you do not wish to be marked/graded.

5. Review your answers carefully, paying attention to your grammar, spelling, and punctuati as well as to relevant textual elements (e.g., paragraphing, cohesion & coherence), as part of mark for each question will be given to language accuracy and text organization

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PART A

Answer ALL FOUR Questions (20 marks)

Question 1:

The noun groups (NGs) below all involve one or more postmodifiers. Circle the head noun (HN) and underline the postmodifiers in each Noun Group. Then, **identify the form** of each postmodifier *as a prepositional group, a finite embedded clause, and/or a non-finite embedded clause.*

(5 marks; each circled HN and underlined postmodifier = 0.5 mark and each label = 0.5 mark)

1. the book on modern linguistics with comprehensive case studies

2. a series of experiments conducted over five years

3. the lecture notes provided by the guest professor yesterday

4. research findings that challenge established economic theories

5. a database of historical documents from the eighteenth century

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Question 2:

Each of the following clauses has different types of lexical cohesion indicated by the words/phrases in **bold**. Write the type of lexical cohesion for each as:

- **Repetition** (same word repeated)
- **Antonymy** (words with opposite meanings)
- **Synonymy** (words with similar meanings)
- **Meronymy** (part-whole relationship)
- **Co-meronymy** (two words that are parts of the same whole)
- **Hyponymy** (specific term related to a general category)
- **Co-hyponymy** (two or more words that fall under the same category)

(5 marks: 1 mark each)

1. The **wheel**, the **tire**, and the **hub** form the essential parts of a car's axle.

2. He opened the **book**, flipped the pages, and read the **book** carefully.

3. **Literature** includes **novels**, **poems**, and **short stories**.

4. The boy was **happy**, and his sister felt **joyful**.

5. **Roses**, **tulips**, and **orchids** were arranged beautifully in the garden.

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Question 3:

Each of the following clauses has different types of grammatical cohesion indicated by the words/phrases in **bold**. Write the type of grammatical cohesion for each as: ***text connector, anaphoric reference, cataphoric reference, noun substitution, verb substitution, clause substitution, or ellipsis.***

(5 marks: 1 mark each)

1. He is brilliant at physics; **so** is his younger brother.

_____

2. The university introduced new policies. **These** will affect international students the most.

_____

3. I could not attend the meeting, but my colleague **did**.

_____

4. The professor explained the concept clearly, and **therefore** the students understood it well.

_____

5. When **he** submitted his thesis, John felt relieved after months of research.

_____

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Question 4:

Underline the theme(s) in the following clauses and identify each as **marked or unmarked**.

(5 marks: underlining theme(s) = 0.5 mark and labelling the theme(s) = 0.5)

1. In the introduction of the thesis, the researcher outlined the key objectives.

2. The participants in the study were selected from three universities.

3. Beyond the expected results, the data revealed surprising patterns.

4. The library's digital resources are accessible to all enrolled students.

5. During the lecture, several students asked critical questions.

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PART B
Two Writing Questions
Answer ONLY ONE (10 marks)

Question 1:

Write an extended definition paragraph for FOUR of the following terms (70-100 words) in which you define, explain, and discuss the following grammatical terms and concepts clearly and fully as they are discussed in the relevant course unit materials. Support your answers with relevant examples to illustrate your understanding, using your own words. ***(10 marks)***

1. Substitution ***(2.5 marks)***
2. Spontaneity ***(2.5 marks)***
3. Medium ***(2.5 marks)***
4. Co-reference ***(2.5 marks)***
5. Text connectors ***(2.5 marks)***

Question 2:

Read the two texts below carefully to establish their overall context and answer the following questions in an interpretation essay (300 to 350 words): (10 marks)

1. What is the topic/the subject matter of each text and the mode of communication? ***(2 marks)***

2. How does the formality/role of language differ between the two texts? ***(2 marks)***

3. What is the role of passive voice in each text, and how does it affect the tone/agency? ***(2 marks)***

4. How does the use of dysfluencies, such as pronouns and contractions, differ between the two texts, affecting the level of spontaneity? ***(2 marks)***

5. What is the role of nominalization in packing meaning in each text? ***(2 marks)***

Your answer should be comprehensive, clear, and focused. Illustrate your answers with appropriate examples from the given text. Use your own words.

Text 1: Remote Learning and Student Engagement

Since the global pandemic, remote learning has become a permanent fixture in many educational systems. Online platforms now serve as the main medium for lectures, discussions, and assessments, enabling flexible access to learning materials. Research has shown that students benefit from the accessibility and convenience of virtual classrooms. However, concerns remain regarding student engagement, as distractions at home, reduced face-to-face interaction, and uneven access to digital resources affect performance. In response, institutions are developing strategies such as interactive tools, breakout rooms, and blended learning models to enhance participation. While remote learning offers long-term advantages in terms of accessibility,

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ensuring active engagement and equitable opportunities remains a challenge for educators worldwide.

Text 2: The Growth of Renewable Energy

Renewable Energy has become central to discussions of sustainable development. Solar, wind, and hydropower are being adopted worldwide as alternatives to fossil fuels, offering the potential to reduce greenhouse gas emissions significantly. Over the last decade, investments in renewable energy infrastructure have increased, leading to improved technology and declining costs. Despite progress, challenges persist in storage capacity, energy transmission, and policy frameworks need further development to ensure reliability. Governments and private companies alike are investing in large-scale projects, while households increasingly adopt solar panels for individual use. As awareness of climate change grows, renewable energy is likely to play a decisive role in shaping the future of global energy production.

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